LESSON 7

Experiencing God's Power

Primary Scripture: Romans 7:15–25; Galatians 5:16–25

Supporting Scriptures: Romans 8:1–11; John 15:4–5; Ephesians 5:18; 1 John 1:9

Memory Verse: Galatians 5:16

Central Teaching Truth

The Christian life is not sustained by determination alone. God works in His people through the Holy Spirit, calling us to depend on Christ, turn from sin, and bear spiritual fruit.

Lesson Objective

Recognize the limits of self-reliance and learn practical ways to depend upon Christ and the Holy Spirit.

Introduction

Have you ever known the right thing to do and still failed to do it? Paul describes a painful conflict with sin in Romans 7. His cry for deliverance points us to Jesus Christ, while Romans 8 explains the new life God supplies by His Spirit.

1. Observation — What Does Scripture Say?

Read Romans 7:15–25 and Galatians 5:16–25.

1. What conflict does Paul describe between his desires and his actions?

2. Who is the source of deliverance in Romans 7:24–25?

3. What contrast does Galatians 5 draw between the works of the flesh and the fruit of the Spirit?

2. Interpretation — What Does Scripture Mean?

Romans 7 exposes the inability of human effort to defeat sin. Paul directs attention beyond himself to Jesus Christ, not to a more impressive personal resolution.

Galatians 5:16 commands believers to walk by the Spirit. The fruit listed in verses 22–23 describes character the Spirit produces; it is not a checklist for earning acceptance with God.

Dependence is active, not passive: believers pray, obey Scripture, confess sin, resist temptation, and trust God's sustaining power. The "spiritual breathing" illustration in the original study can help us remember confession and renewed surrender, but is not a biblical formula.

Teaching Diagram — Where Is My Dependence?

Self-Reliance	Spirit-Directed Living
I rely on willpower alone	I depend on Christ and obey His Word
Sinful attitudes remain unchecked	I confess and turn from sin
I seek credit for change	I give thanks for the Spirit's fruit

3. Application — How Do We Live God's Word?

1. Where have I been relying on my strength instead of trusting God?

2. Which work of the flesh must I turn away from, and which fruit of the Spirit should I cultivate?

Personal Action Step

Each morning read Galatians 5:16 and pray for a Spirit-directed life. When you recognize sin, confess it promptly and take a concrete step of repentance. At week's end, record one way you saw growth.

Group Discussion

Why is "trying harder" by itself not the same as walking in the Spirit?

Closing Prayer

Father, help me recognize my weakness without despair. Teach me to rely on Jesus Christ, turn from sin, and walk by Your Spirit. Amen.

LESSON 8

Appointed as Ambassadors

Primary Scripture: 2 Corinthians 5:17–21

Supporting Scriptures: Matthew 9:35–38; Luke 19:10; Philippians 3:20; 1 Peter 3:15; Colossians 4:5–6

Memory Verse: Matthew 9:36

Central Teaching Truth

Those reconciled to God through Christ are called to represent Him faithfully through compassionate conduct and truthful words.

Lesson Objective

Understand Christ's ministry of reconciliation and practice representing Him with integrity, compassion, and the gospel.

Introduction

An ambassador represents someone greater than himself. In 2 Corinthians 5, Paul describes a ministry of reconciliation entrusted to believers. We speak for Christ faithfully, while recognizing that God is the One who reconciles people to Himself.

1. Observation — What Does Scripture Say?

Read 2 Corinthians 5:17–21 and Matthew 9:36.

1. What has God accomplished through Christ according to 2 Corinthians 5:18–19?

2. What appeal do Christ's ambassadors make in verse 20?

3. What did Jesus see in the crowds, and how did He respond?

2. Interpretation — What Does Scripture Mean?

Reconciliation begins with God's gracious action in Christ. Because Christ dealt with sin, believers can announce the good news and urge people to be reconciled to God.

An ambassador is accountable to the One represented. Our behavior should reflect Jesus: honesty, humility, compassion, patience, and love. Yet a good example does not replace the spoken message about Christ.

The goal is not to win arguments or pressure people. We speak truthfully and respectfully (1 Peter 3:15), leaving the outcome to God.

Teaching Diagram — Representing Christ

Our Identity	Our Calling	Our Response
Reconciled through Christ	Ambassadors for Christ	Show compassion
Belonging to Christ	Message of reconciliation	Speak the gospel truthfully

3. Application — How Do We Live God's Word?

1. What does my conduct communicate about Jesus to my neighbors or family?

2. Who could I encourage, listen to, or share the gospel with this week?

Personal Action Step

Choose one person to serve with compassion this week. Pray for that person, take one caring action, and be ready to explain your hope in Christ in a gentle, clear way.

Group Discussion

How do both our character and our words contribute to representing Christ faithfully?

Closing Prayer

Lord Jesus, give me Your compassion for people. Help me represent You with integrity and speak Your gospel with truth, grace, and courage. Amen.

LESSON 9

Walking in the Spirit

Primary Scripture: Galatians 5:16–25

Supporting Scriptures: Romans 8:1–14; Colossians 1:13–14; Ephesians 6:10–18; James 4:7; 1 Peter 5:8–9

Memory Verse: 2 Corinthians 5:7

Central Teaching Truth

Believers belong to Christ and are called to walk by faith, resist the flesh, and stand firm in God's provision amid spiritual conflict.

Lesson Objective

Understand our identity in Christ, identify spiritual conflicts accurately, and respond through faith-filled obedience and God's Word.

Introduction

Faithful Christian living is not the absence of struggle. The Scriptures teach that believers face temptation, the desires of the flesh, worldly pressures, and spiritual opposition. God calls His people to stand firm rather than trust in fear or their own strength.

1. Observation — What Does Scripture Say?

Read Galatians 5:16–25, Romans 8:1–14, and Ephesians 6:10–18.

1. What are believers commanded to do in Galatians 5:16 and 25?

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2. According to Romans 8, how does the Spirit relate to our new identity and conduct?

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3. What does Paul tell Christians to put on in Ephesians 6, and why?

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2. Interpretation — What Does Scripture Mean?

To walk in the Spirit means continually ordering our lives under the Spirit's direction, in keeping with the truth of Scripture. It includes ordinary decisions, relationships, and responses to temptation.

Romans 8 grounds growth in what God has done through Christ: there is no condemnation for those in Christ Jesus (verse 1). Obedience flows from grace rather than serving as a way to earn it.

Ephesians 6 uses the image of armor to call believers to spiritual alertness and steadfastness in truth, righteousness, faith, salvation, God's Word, and prayer. Spiritual warfare does not excuse personal wrongdoing or remove our responsibility to love others.

Teaching Diagram — Standing Firm

Spiritual Challenge	God's Provision	Faithful Response
Temptation	Spirit and Scripture	Resist and obey
Fear and opposition	Faith and prayer	Stand firm in Christ
Worldly pressure	Truth and righteousness	Live differently

3. Application — How Do We Live God's Word?

1. Which circumstances tempt me to react in fear, bitterness, or self-reliance?

2. What specific truth from Scripture can shape my response when temptation comes?

Personal Action Step

Read Ephesians 6:10–18 on three days this week. Identify one pressure or temptation; pray, recall God's Word, and choose a specific obedient response. Share what you learned with a trusted believer.

Group Discussion

How does knowing our identity in Christ help us face spiritual conflict without fear or pride?

Closing Prayer

Heavenly Father, remind me that I belong to Christ. Strengthen me through Your Word and Spirit to stand firm, resist evil, and live by faith. Amen.